

Closed-source software:

As one may expect, this is pretty much on the other end of the spectrum from open-source software - in that it offers very limited cross-platform compatibility and the software is more or less immutable-meaning, very less scope for improvisation. You pretty much get what you get.

Proprietary software:

Proprietary means that the software functions solely for the products of one particular manufacturer. This could have both advantages and disadvantages. The main advantage is that since it's tailor made for one particular manufacturer, all the devices that come from that manufacturer would function all too well with it. The major-and obvious- disadvantage is that it will be hard to introduce devices from other manufacturers into the network.

A look at some of the more popular home automation software

While there are quite a few home automation software out there, the ones that are actually quite efficient are a handful. And of those, there are only a few which actually make the cut for being popular for the right reasons. Here, we list a few of them. Coincidentally or not, they fall in the open source category. But hey, that's not a bad thing!

OpenHAB

Creators of open source platforms are usually proud about the fact that they make stuff open source. And rightly so- for it's more participative and democratic than closed systems. The creators of OpenHAB certainly seem to be proud of the fact given how the word 'Open' is splashed right there on the name of the software.

OpenHAB is expanded as Open Home Automation Bus and is quite popular, enjoying a pretty large user base. The source code of OpenHAB is licensed under the Eclipse Public License and can be easily found online. It's among the most easily portable tools and can run efficiently even on microcomputers.

The software is written in the Java programming language and supports literally hundreds of home devices. In fact, it's been designed to be device-



Good software, but if you're not down with programming, you'll have a hard time setting it up